

THE CEMENT RUSH

As UltraTech Cement and Ambuja Cements look to expand organically and undertake major buyouts, the sector is set for a dramatic change. What lies ahead?

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PHOTOS BY BANDEEP SINGH

CONCRETE SUCCESS

1

Holcim entered India in 2005 through the acquisitions of Ambuja and ACC, making it the largest player, followed by UltraTech Cement

2

Lafarge and Holcim merged globally. The restructuring slowed down Holcim in India, leading to limited organic growth and no buyouts

3

UltraTech then entered the M&A game and quickly acquired assets, boosting capacity and market share

4

The Adani Group bought over Holcim India's assets in 2022 for \$10.5 billion

5

Since then, there has been a frenetic M&A race between Ambuja Cements and UltraTech, with the South in focus